

01 SMALL TALK

What's your go-to coffee or drink when you meet up with someone?

Do you have any plans with friends this weekend?

Are you more of a 'meet in person' person or a 'chat online' person?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

1 ~~"We promised to meet next week."~~
✓ "We made plans to meet next week."
가벼운 약속엔 'promise'가 너무 무거워요. 'make plans'가 자연스러워요.

2 ~~"We are very close friend."~~
✓ "We're really close friends."
주어가 'we'(둘 이상)면 'friend'도 복수 'friends'가 돼야 해요.

3 ~~"I cannot contact to her."~~
✓ "I can't reach her."
'contact'는 'to' 없이 바로 목적어를 써요. 회화에선 'reach'가 더 자연스러워요.

03 오늘의 워업

앞은 자리에서 시계방향으로 돌아가며, 각자 A 또는 B를 골라 한 단어로 외치고 가능하면 이유를 한 마디만 붙여요. 5라운드를 빠르게 진행하세요.

WARM-UP

This or That · 빠른 5라운드

1

Text VS Call

2

Big group VS One-on-one

3

Plan ahead VS Go with the flow

4

Always early VS Right on time

5

Coffee VS Tea

FRIENDSHIP · MAIN DISCUSSION

Canceling Plans With Coffee Money — Thoughtful or Too Transactional?

BACKGROUND

약속을 취소하면서 커피값을 보내는 행동은 센스 있는 사과처럼 보일 수도 있고, 돈으로 상황을 마무리하려는 느낌을 줄 수도 있어요. 말로만 하는 것보다 구체적인 보상이 있어 고맙게 느껴질 수 있지만, 관계가 거래처럼 느껴질 수도 있죠. 이 기준은 취소 이유와 타이밍에 따라 크게 달라져요. 갑작스러운 야근이나 몸 상태 때문에 어쩔 수 없었다면 이해하기 쉽지만, 자주 반복되면 커피값보다 태도가 더 중요해져요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

Sending coffee money after canceling plans can feel thoughtful because it turns an apology into a small action. It says, "I know I wasted your time a little, and I want to make it up to you." But the same gesture can also feel transactional, as if the person is paying a fee instead of caring about the friendship. Context changes everything: how late they canceled, whether it happens often, and whether they explain sincerely. A small gift cannot fix every cancellation, but it can soften the moment when the relationship already feels respectful. The follow-up matters as much as the apology. If the person suggests another time and changes the habit next time, the small payment can feel considerate. Without that effort, the money can feel like a shortcut instead of real care.

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

cancel at the last minute — 막판에 약속을 취소하다

make plans — 약속을 잡다

take it personally — 기분 나쁘게 받아들이다

reschedule / lock in a new date — 약속을 다시 잡다

my bad — 내 잘못이야, 미안

keep score — 관계에서 일일이 따지고 계산하다

TRY THESE PHRASES

Honestly, I'd feel touched — it shows my friend still cares.

It depends on the friend, but usually a little awkward at first.

I'd say a small gift helps, because actions speak louder than words.

The way I see it, the words matter more than any gift.

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'send a gifticon' or a 'just say sorry' person when you cancel on someone?
- 2 When was the last time you canceled plans on a friend? How did you smooth it over?
- 3 On a scale of 1 to 5, how often do you send a little gifticon to say sorry or thanks?
- 4 What's your usual move when a friend cancels on you at the last minute?

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. If a friend cancels and sends you coffee money, do you feel touched or a little awkward? Why?

↳ *Honestly, I'd feel touched — it shows my friend still cares.*

↳ *It depends on the friend, but usually a little awkward at first.*

Q2. Does a small gift make an apology feel more sincere, or are the words more important?

↳ *I'd say a small gift helps, because actions speak louder than words.*

↳ *The way I see it, the words matter more than any gift.*

Q3. What matters most after a canceled plan — the reason, the timing, or the follow-up?

↳ *What matters most to me is the follow-up, like suggesting a new date.*

↳ *It really comes down to the reason behind the cancel.*

Q4. If the same friend cancels again and again, does coffee money still help?

↳ *When it keeps happening, the coffee money starts to mean less.*

↳ *If I'm honest, it still helps a little — at least they feel sorry.*

Q5. What would feel better to you than coffee money in this situation?

↳ *I'd much rather have them lock in a new date right away.*

↳ *What would feel better is a real apology, not just money.*